Wucu — Seven Days

Seven small instruments, one for each day of the week.



The weekday series is seven iOS apps, each named after a day of the week in Old English. *Wucu* is the Old English word for “week”.

Some of them were built so that their insides could be connected like a modular synthesizer — almost everything that moves inside them can be sent to move something else. I made them to be used with that understanding.

But doing that on the small screen of an iPhone began to feel impossible. The buttons, and the small text that shows the connections, are not easy to use — I can’t say their usability is high. In the end, they make sense to the person who made them, and they may be hard to follow for many others.

So the weekday series became something else: a set of experimental apps, and the ground that the apps I am making now stand on.

COMING SOON

The bundle

The seven will be released together as a bundle, Wucu – Seven Days, on the App Store. Each app can still be bought on its own, but the bundle costs about half as much as buying all seven separately.

EACH APP	BUNDLE · ALL SEVEN
$4.99	$17.99

THE SEVEN

Who they are



Mōnandæg

MONDAY

The collector.

Eight sound files, folded into one another. Record, or load sounds of any length, choose the part to read, and let the eight bend each other through wavefolding and linked modulation.

App Store → apps.apple.com/app/id6814002096



Tīwesdæg

TUESDAY

The quarrelling pair.

Two sound files read as oscillators. A stepped, chaotic register makes each one push the other around. Sixteen pads in a four-by-four grid.

App Store → apps.apple.com/app/id6813998626



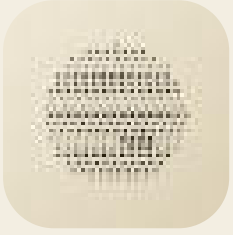
Wōdnesdæg

WEDNESDAY

The calm one.

A chord drone of sixteen sine waves. Pick a chord and the spare voices stack themselves in octaves and fifths. Just or equal tuning, a slight left–right shift, and a play mode where chords overlap and dissolve with long releases.

App Store → apps.apple.com/app/id6813871881



Þunresdæg

THURSDAY

The mathematician.

Sound from equations. The tent map, logistic, circle, Hénon and Lorenz systems become oscillators and modulators, and their orbits are drawn faintly on the pads while they play.

App Store → apps.apple.com/app/id6813862696

Who they are, continued



Frīgedæg

FRIDAY

The listener.

Records the sound around you and breaks it into microsound. Grains arrive in swarms and fall silent, like insects. One engine, eight parameters carved out on four pads, live or from a recording.

App Store → apps.apple.com/app/id6813849843



Sæternesdæg

SATURDAY

The unruly one.

A single oscillator sent through a chain of through-zero FM, wave shaping, pulse division and XOR logic — then fed back into its own sync and FM. It is meant to go off the rails.

App Store → apps.apple.com/app/id6807687659



Sunnandæg

SUNDAY

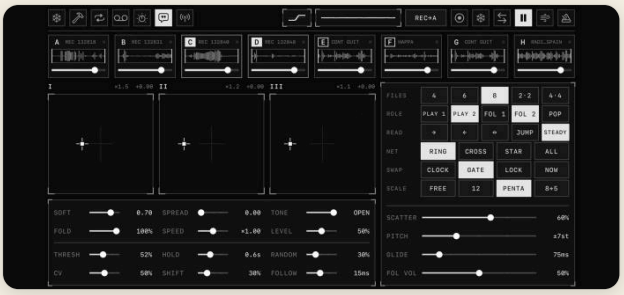
The first one.

Where it began. One sine wave through three wavefolders, its output returned to itself. Four pads, the camera, the tilt of the phone and a ball rolling under gravity all bend that loop — and every moving part can be patched to every other.

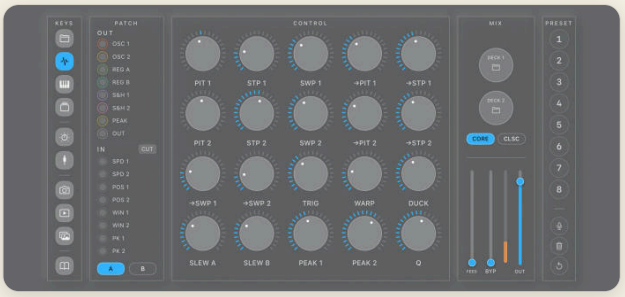
App Store → apps.apple.com/app/id6807615298

THE SEVEN

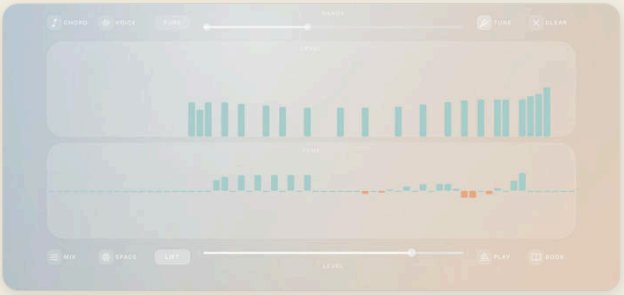
Main screens



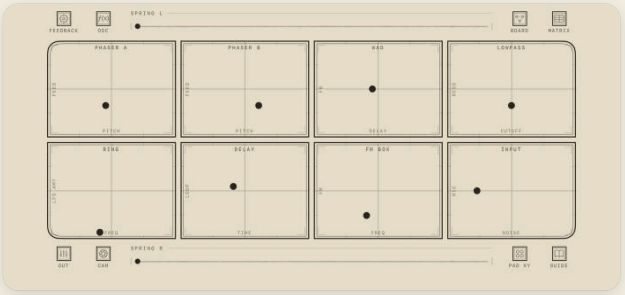
01 Mōnandæg MONDAY



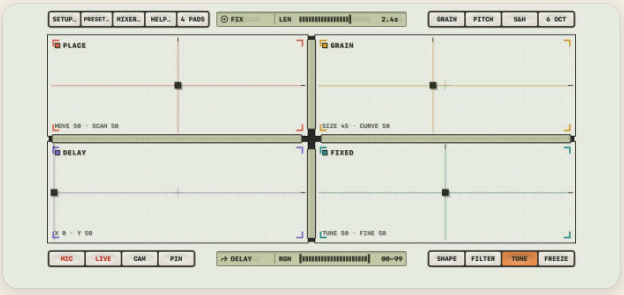
02 Tīwesdæg TUESDAY



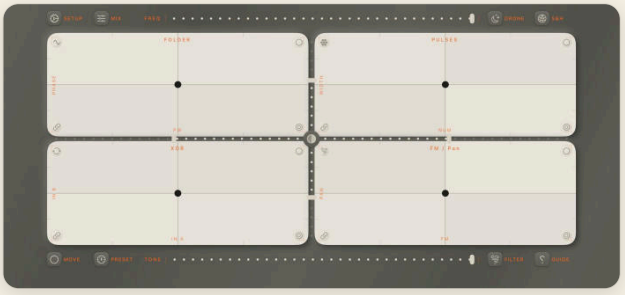
03 Wōdnesdæg WEDNESDAY



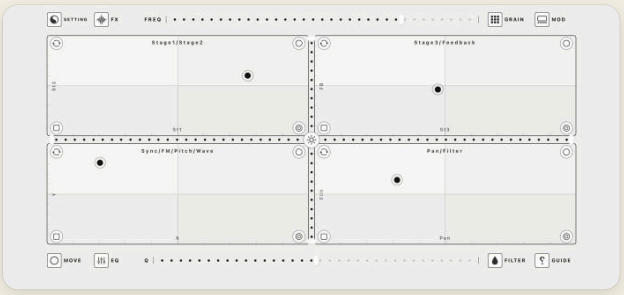
04 Þunresdæg THURSDAY



05 Frīgedæg FRIDAY



06 Sæternesdæg SATURDAY



07 Sunnandæg SUNDAY

WUCU — SEVEN DAYS

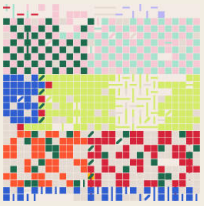
Seven screens, one for each day. All played sideways, on an iPhone, with the fingers.

$4.99 each · $17.99 for all seven

WHAT COMES NEXT

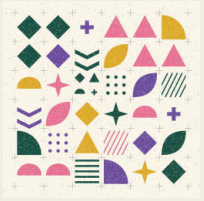
These lead to

What I learned from the seven days went into the next apps — fewer controls on screen, and the connections kept inside.



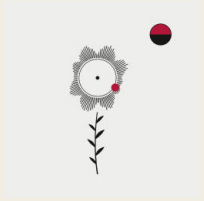
Espalier

A synthesizer made only of chorus and delay — a chorus fed back into itself, right at the edge of singing.



Speculae

Grown from Thursday's twin phaser and wave shaper. Simple, patchable, and it remembers where you have been.



Humusmus

A modular sampler for field recordings. Sound files drawn as plant specimens, linked to each other — and small insects that land on the flowers and move things around.

These new apps will go live as soon as they pass App Store review. Some of them will get their first update right after release. I will let you know when they are out.

I am also working on experimental AU plugins, controllers for instruments such as the OP-1 and the S-4, and some companion apps. I will tell you about those another time.

I make these alone, slowly, by watching how sound behaves. Ideas and requests for the apps are always welcome.

— k.odk